

Sanjog Gupta: Our goal is to engage a billion viewers with IPL 2025

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JioStar, the newly formed entity from Disney's Star India and Reliance's Viacom18, is gearing up to make the 2025 Indian Premier League (IPL) the biggest edition yet, targeting over a billion viewers across platforms.

"Our ambition continues to be about growth," said Sanjog Gupta, CEO-Sports at JioStar. "We are aspiring to make this the biggest IPL ever — both in terms of viewership and the business around it."

With television and digital rights under one roof, JioStar plans to engage audiences through multiple feeds and formats. "For IPL 2025, we will have about 25 concurrent feeds catering to different cohorts of fans," Gupta revealed. Regional platforms will play a crucial role, with broadcasts tailored to local preferences.

"What started as a language foray in 2013 with the addition of Hindi is now a complete reconstitution of the broadcast experience," he noted. Using Karnataka and Tamil Nadu as examples, he highlighted how regional broadcasts reflect cultural differences. "Virat (Kohli) is the most popular player in Karnataka, while Dhoni is in Tamil Nadu. This influences how home team affinity is expressed in each feed."

JioStar is also focusing on younger audiences. "We are using animated characters Motu and Patlu, who are very popular with kids, to present IPL in a way they can relate to," Gupta said. "They will do commentary, host segments, and have their own shows."

The record-breaking ICC Champions Trophy final set a high bar for cricket viewership, but Gupta

believes IPL remains a steady draw. "Unlike ICC events, where sentiment is tied to the Indian team's performance, IPL is more consistent in terms of engagement." Despite non-stop cricket throughout the year, Gupta sees no risk of audience fatigue. "We see it as an opportunity. Consumers don't have to switch platforms to watch cricket — they can find everything in one place."

JioStar is eyeing untapped audiences, particularly households without traditional living room TVs. "There are 650 million smartphones and 200 million feature phones with connectivity. That presents massive headroom for digital growth."

With its expansive approach, JioStar is betting on IPL's unmatched ability to bring in new viewers. "There is no bigger recruiter of audiences than live cricket in this country, and particularly IPL," Gupta concluded.



Biggest ever opening weekend

137 cr digital views — Highest ever 35% growth YoY

25.3 cr TV reach (viewers) — Highest ever 14% growth YoY

39% — Growth YoY in TVR

4956 cr minutes of watch time (TV & digital) — Highest ever 33% growth YoY